

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

Missouri — NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City) Jurisdiction — May 2026

NAPCS Unionization Research • May 2026 • Template v8.0

Section 1: State Overview

State	Missouri
Labor Board	NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City) — National Labor Relations Board — Region 14 (St. Louis) and Region 17 (Kansas City). Missouri State Board of Mediation (SLBA) has limited jurisdiction and does not cover independently incorporated charters.
Governing Law	RSMo Chapter 160.400-160.425 (Missouri charter school law). RSMo 160.400.1: "A charter school is an independent public school." RSMo 160.420: employment provisions (individual employee retention option only — no blanket district-CBA carryover). Mo. Const. Art. I 29: public-employee collective bargaining right (Independence-NEA v. Independence Sch. Dist., 2007). RSMo 105.510 excludes all teachers from the statutory public-sector labor act.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — MO charters operated by nonprofit corporations are private employers under the NLRA. NLRB R14 (St. Louis) and R17 (Kansas City) are the operative boards. KIPP St. Louis High decertification (14-RD-341432) confirms NLRB jurisdiction. SLBA exception possible only for KCPS/SLPS-sponsored schools if employer-of-record is the district (verify).
Right-to-Work	NOT a Right-to-Work State — Missouri right-to-work law (RSMo §290.590, enacted 2017) was rejected by voter referendum August 7, 2018 (67% opposed). Missouri has no operative right-to-work statute. Union security provisions are available in collective bargaining agreements. (Missouri voters rejected right-to-work 67-33% in August 2018. The 2017 statute never took effect. Union security clauses are available in MO charter school CBAs under NLRA.)
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — NLRB secret-ballot election required (private employer). NOT right-to-work: 2017 RTW law (SB 19) repealed by voters via Proposition A, Aug 7 2018 (~67% against). Missouri is a non-RTW state — union security agreements are permissible.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — May 2026 (Registry v69) — 81 charter schools searched
Research Window	May 29, 2026

Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Total charter schools in Missouri: 81 (Charter School Registry v69 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 83 charter schools in Missouri as of May 2026). Registry v94 audit June 5, 2026: 81 Open. 1 Closed (Kansas City Girls Prep) + 1 Future (BELIEVE Academy STL) excluded per census methodology.). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Total Unionized Charter Schools in Missouri (active certifications)	0	0%	Zero active NLRB certifications. The one MO charter that organized (KIPP St. Louis High) was decertified May 2024.
Confirmed — Independent Certification (active)	0	0%	No active NLRB certification for any MO charter school as of May 2026.
Decertified — Formerly Organized	1	N/A	KIPP St. Louis High (14-RD-341432) — AFT Local 420

			certified Nov 2022; decertified May 29, 2024 (19-17, NRTW-assisted). First St. Louis charter union; no first contract ever ratified.
Unverified — No Records Found (Full Protocol Complete)	69	85% of open schools	69 open schools: NLRB R14/R17 ADS + full 8-step non-portal protocol + W1-W4 WATCH steps complete. No signals found.
Closed — Within/Pending Lookback Confirmation	1	N/A	Kansas City Girls Prep High (KCPS-sponsored) — Registry v69 shows Closed; closure date not populated (lookback status pending confirmation). No union found.
Total Charter Schools (MO universe — Registry v69)	83	100%	81 Open + 1 Closed + 1 Future (BELIEVE Academy STL, not yet open). Two metros: Kansas City (R17) and St. Louis (R14).

Charter School Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	25,751 students — 2.9% of state K–12 enrollment (889,059 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	20,690 students in network-affiliated schools — 80.3% of total charter enrollment
Students in Organized Charter Schools	0 students documented
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
KIPP Missouri	Network‡	8	—	—	3,116
Confluence Academies	Network‡	6	—	—	2,460
Allen Village	Network‡	5	—	—	384
Frontier Schools	Network‡	5	—	—	1,587
Academie Lafayette	Network‡	4	—	—	1,425
Gateway Science Academy	Network‡	4	—	—	1,666
Momentum Academy	Network‡	4	—	—	599
Hogan Preparatory Academy	Network‡	3	—	—	843

University Academy	Network‡	3	—	—	1,111
Guadalupe Centers Schools	Network‡	3	—	—	1,614
Lift for Life Academy	Network‡	3	—	—	865
Crossroads Charter Schools	Network‡	3	—	—	1,003
Brookside Charter School	Network‡	2	—	—	800
City Garden Montessori	Network‡	2	—	—	589
North Side Community School	Network‡	2	—	—	433
DeLaSalle Charter School	Network‡	2	—	—	220
Ewing Marion Kauffman School	Network‡	2	—	—	961
Citizens of the World Charter School - Kansas City	Network‡	2	—	—	388
Kairos Academies	Network‡	2	—	—	515
Kansas City Girls Preparatory Academy	Network‡	1	—	—	111
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Missouri		66		—	20,690
of which organized				—	—

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in Missouri. Organized network schools: 0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters.

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133.

Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

20 network (type unclassified). Approximately 15 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of May 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

RSMo Chapter 160.400-160.425 (Missouri charter school law). RSMo 160.400.1: "A charter school is an independent public school." RSMo 160.420: employment provisions (individual employee retention option only — no blanket district-CBA carryover). Mo. Const. Art. I 29: public-employee collective bargaining right (Independence-NEA v. Independence Sch. Dist., 2007). RSMo 105.510 excludes all teachers from the statutory public-sector labor act. Missouri is not a right-to-work state (Missouri right-to-work law (RSMo §290.590, enacted 2017) was rejected by voter referendum August 7, 2018 (67% opposed). Missouri has no operative right-to-work statute. Union security provisions are available in collective bargaining agreements.). Charter schools in Missouri are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City)). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter School Structure

Missouri operates 81 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 25,751 students. 20 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Missouri. The largest networks by campus count are KIPP Missouri (8 campuses in state), Confluence Academies (6 campuses in state), Allen Village (5 campuses in state). Approximately 15 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation.

Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Missouri charter labor coverage centers entirely on KIPP St. Louis High. The St. Louis Post-Dispatch and The Labor Tribune covered the November 2022 certification, the April 2024 one-day strikes, and the May 2024 decertification (19-17). Coverage documented ~50% annual staff turnover at the 440-student school and the dispute over third-party grievance arbitration and just-cause termination. Grand Center Arts Academy's 2015 organizing received limited contemporaneous coverage. No Kansas City charter organizing coverage found.

Stakeholder Communications

AFT St. Louis Local 420 publicly framed the KIPP decertification as an NRTW-driven loss while crediting its campaign with the 10% raises KIPP ultimately offered. Local 420 also represents St. Louis Public Schools teachers. No AFT communications referencing Kansas City charter organizing found. KIPP St. Louis leadership (executive director Garrett Kelly) maintained through the dispute that raises could not be awarded during bargaining under federal law; the documented posture included refusal of third-party grievance arbitration and just-cause termination protections.

Legislative Context

Missouri Proposition A (Aug 7, 2018): voters repealed the 2017 right-to-work law (SB 19) ~67% to 33% — the first state to reverse an enacted RTW law by referendum. Mo. Const. Art. I 29 (Independence-NEA v. Independence Sch. Dist., 2007): public employees, including teachers, have a constitutional collective-bargaining right, though RSMo 105.510 excludes teachers from the statutory public-sector labor act. RSMo 160.400-160.425: charter law confines charters to specified districts and defines them as independent public schools.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

NLRB R14 (St. Louis) + NLRB R17 (Kansas City) public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may require a records request for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
No active certified union contracts in MO charter school community	N/A (KIPP St. Louis High AFT Local 420 unit decertified May 2024 before any CBA; Grand Center Arts 2015 attempt produced no CBA)	NONE FOUND N/A	Request: Region14@nrlb.gov